

## INTERNATIONAL news

### STMicro, GlobalFoundries partner to build Euro 7.4B chip facility in France

STMicroelectronics and GlobalFoundries have partnered to build a multi-billion advanced chip facility in Crolles, France. The facility is expected to become fully operational by 2027 with a production capacity of 620,000 300mm wafers per year. The project will



employ nearly 1,000 workers. The chips produced at the facility will be dedicated to FD-SOI (fully depleted silicon on insulator) technology, developed in Europe, and will significantly reduce power consumption. The French government is providing financial assistance of 2.9 billion euros (\$3.10 billion) for the project, which costs 7.4 billion euros. The project received approval from the European Commission and aligns with the objectives of the European Chips Act and the 'France 2030' plan.

### Keysight Technologies to acquire ESI Group for Euro 913M

To expand its software prototyping capabilities in computer-aided engineering, Keysight Technologies is set to acquire ESI Group for 913 million euros in an all-cash transaction. The offer values ESI Group's fully diluted share capital at 913 million euros. The completion of the acquisition is expected in Q4 2023. ESI Group provides virtual prototyping solutions in the automotive and aerospace sectors. The acquisition comes when industries increasingly focus on virtualisation for product prototyping, manufacturing processes, and workflows.

### Foxconn partners with Stellantis to design and sell auto chips

Foxconn has partnered with Netherlands-based Stellantis to form a 50-50 joint venture, SiliconAuto, to design and sell

semiconductors for the automotive industry from 2026. The joint venture will supply Stellantis, Foxconn, and other customers with Stellantis' new STLA Brain electronic and software architecture. SiliconAuto will be based in the Netherlands. The two companies had earlier signed a preliminary agreement in December 2021. Stellantis and Foxconn already have a Mobile Drive joint venture for developing in-car and connected-car technologies.

### Airbus, STMicro partner for power electronics R&D on aircraft electrification

Airbus and STMicroelectronics have partnered to research and develop lighter power electronics for future hybrid-powered aircraft and electric urban air vehicles. The cooperation will involve the development of SiC and GaN devices, packages, and modules specifically tailored for aerospace applications. Wide bandgap semiconductors have superior electrical properties as compared to traditional semiconductors, enabling the development of smaller, lighter, and more efficient electronic devices and systems. Advanced research and tests will be conducted on demonstrators such as e-motor control units, high- and low-voltage power converters, and wireless power transfer systems.

### EU, Japan to strengthen chip cooperation, says Bretton

The European Union (EU) and Japan will deepen cooperation on semiconductors by monitoring the chip supply chain and facilitating the exchange of researchers and engineers, industry chief Thierry Bretton said. The EU would support Japanese semiconductor companies operating within the bloc, while Japan would offer subsidies to revitalise its chip industry and drive consolidation. The deepening cooperation aims to reduce the EU's dependence on China for high-end technology. The EU and Japan will cooperate on undersea cable connectivity, semiconductors, cybersecurity, and other areas of the digital economy.

### Harwin partners with European distributor Transfer Multisort Elektronik

Harwin has announced a new supply channel partnership with European distributor Transfer Multisort Elektronik (TME). TME's logistics centre near Łódź will stock a diverse range of Harwin product lines, including its HRI, BBI, and EZI product categories.

### Tamil Nadu tops electronics exports with \$5.37B in FY23

Tamil Nadu emerged as India's top exporter of electronic goods in FY23, with exports reaching \$5.37 billion, nearly triple the previous year's figure. The state surpassed Uttar Pradesh, Karnataka, and Maharashtra in electronic goods exports, benefiting from the production of companies like Tata Electronics and Pegatron. This state was single-handedly responsible for 11.98% of India's total electronics goods export in FY21, which doubled to 22.83% in

FY23. It is home to over 15 leading electronics manufacturers, including Foxconn, Tata Electronics, Salcomp, and Pegatron.

### Microchip pours \$300M into expanding India Operations, inaugurates Hyderabad R&D Centre

Microchip Technology announced a \$300 million investment towards expanding its operations in India. The company purchased five floors in the One Golden Mile office building in Kokapet, Hyderabad, for its

relocated research and development (R&D) centre. The \$300M investment will enhance infrastructure in existing R&D centres in Bangalore and Chennai, improve engineering labs, and support customer services in India. Microchip employs around 2,500 individuals in India, supports over 2,000 regional customers, and contributes to various industries.

### Tesla explores establishing auto parts chain in India, sparks renewed interest

Tesla is in talks with the Indian